qualitative elements that determine the strength of a nation.[14]

Whatever may be the varying notions about national power, if we try to define it from a broad perspective, it means the ability to prevail in conflict and overcome obstacles, and this is more so because relations among states involve some form of incompatibility. Therefore, power helps in getting one's way. Influence is one of the methods by which states, like people, try to get their way in international relations. Influence can range from compellance, switching sides in international fora, leaving one alliance and joining another and economic embargo, to deterrence. Deterrence as a policy became very popular during the Cold War when both the superpowers, USA and USSR mutually deterred each other by using the threat of nuclear missiles rather than actually using it to maintain their foothold in world politics and maintaining their spheres of influence. Holsti lists six different tactics in the influence ladder:

1. Use of force
2. Infliction of non-violent punishment
3. Threat of punishment (the *stick*)
4. Granting rewards (the *carrot*)
5. Offer of rewards
6. Persuasion.[15]

States often use a combination of all the above tactics to gain leverage in a particular bargain, either tacit or explicit. Therefore, power becomes an important factor in international relations and to know how it contributes to a states' prowess involves an effort to estimate power. The Chinese strategist *Sun Tzu* advised the rulers to accurately estimate their own power—ranging from money to territory to popular domestic support—and that of their potential enemies. He wrote that it is essential to "Know the enemy and know yourself", and when it comes to the question of estimating national power, it is necessary to know about the elements of national power, since measurement of national power is impossible. As Ebenstein noted that "In the field of international relations, the central problem of the strength of a nation is essentially a problem of qualitative judgement and measurement, as national power is more than the